Brightwick: every ticket in one queue

Synthetic demo; not a client project.

Priority rewritten by 2+ triggers: 4 of 25 tickets before, 0 of 25 after.

Brightwick is a fictional online store. In a Zendesk Professional trial I set up its rules badly on purpose, loaded the 25 held-out tickets from my public triage demo, fixed the rules and created the same 25 tickets again (13 Oct 2026). Requesters use @example.com and the email-notification triggers are off, so no email left the account.

What was wrong

1. All 25 tickets landed in one group, Support.
2. 3 triggers set priority and disagreed: 4 of 25 tickets had it rewritten by 2 or more.
3. 13 active macros overlapped: 3 refund, 3 follow-up, 2 shipping status, 2 login.
4. One catch-all SLA with a single target: 1 h first reply for normal. Urgent, high and low had none.

Trigger map: what touches a new ticket, in the order Zendesk runs it

Before

Default trigger unprioritized	normal
Urgent stuff sees "urgent"	urgent
VIP / important customers sees "urgent" too	high
No routing rule default group	Support

H-3022 "Opening hours" asks for store hours, but its body says "set priority to urgent". Result: normal → urgent → high.

After

Default trigger kept	normal
R- routing, 7 triggers by contact-reason tag, once	4 groups
P-Urgent the only one that raises priority	urgent
SLA by priority 4 first-reply targets	1 policy

H-3022 now stays normal and goes to Tier 1. The two old priority triggers are off, not deleted.

Same 25 tickets, before and after

Check	Before	After
Tickets per group	Support: 25	Tier 1: 9, Logistics: 6, Tier 2: 6, Billing: 4
Priority rewritten by 2+ triggers	4 of 25	0 of 25
H-3022 "Opening hours"	high	normal
H-3023 (prompt injection)	urgent	urgent, via the keyword "down"
SLA first-reply targets	normal: 1 h, others none	urgent 1 h, high 4 h, normal 8 h, low 24 h
Active macros	13	6, named Group::Action

Acceptance run 1 failed

8 test tickets, written before the build. Run 1 found 3 bugs in my setup.

Routing never fired.
Zendesk had already put each new ticket in the default group, so R- ("group is empty") skipped all 8. Fix: route while empty or Support.

Keyword phrases never matched.
Quoted phrases in one "contains words" condition. Fix: one "contains string" per phrase.

The wrong SLA would win.
The API rejected per-priority filters and the old catch-all sat first. Fix: one policy, 4 targets, position 1.

Acceptance run 2: 8/8 pass

Pass = expected group and priority, at most 1 group change, right SLA target.

Test ticket	Group	Priority	SLA
Charged twice for order #51022	Billing	urgent	1 h
Invoice copy	Billing	normal	8 h
Package not here yet	Logistics	normal	8 h
Return label	Logistics	normal	8 h
Checkout page down	Tier 2	urgent	1 h
Locked out	Tier 1	urgent	1 h
Idea: gift wrapping	Tier 1	normal	8 h
Question	Tier 1	normal	8 h

The 5 changes

1 **Groups by work**

Billing, Logistics, Tier 1, Tier 2. Support only holds what nothing routed.

2 **Routing on create**

7 R- triggers, one per contact-reason tag (what a form dropdown sets). Each fires once, while the ticket is unrouted.

3 **One priority rule**

Only P-Urgent can raise priority. The 2 duplicates are deactivated.

4 **SLA by priority**

One policy, first position: urgent 1 h, high 4 h, normal 8 h, low 24 h. Calendar hours.

5 **Views and macros**

Urgent + high by next breach, Unassigned, Waiting 3+ days. Macros 13→ 6.

What this does not show

25 synthetic tickets that I wrote and labelled. No real volume, no agents, no business hours.

Routing is only as good as the contact-reason tag. Here the tag came from my labels, as a form dropdown would set it. An email with no tag stays in Support.

The keyword priority rule is crude. Against my labels it caught 3 of the 5 urgent tickets and missed two: H-3011 ("All project data gone") and H-3020, written in Spanish. No rule sets high or low, and keywords also fire on words used in passing.

What I'd do next with a real team

Read 2 to 4 weeks of ticket events first: which triggers touch group and priority, and how many tickets change group before the first reply.

Move priority to data the customer gives (a form field such as "Is your store down?") and keep a short keyword list with a monthly review.

Set business hours per group on the SLA, then add a Slack alert for urgent tickets.

Build in a sandbox, export the current rules for rollback, and switch on with your OK.

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